

Safety & your data

#	Habit	What to say or do
1	Work on copies	Point it at a copy or test folder until you trust the task.
2	Dry run first	"Show me what you would change and wait for my OK."
3	Read before you approve	Keep approvals on. Don't understand a command? "Explain that before I approve it."
4	Watch what you paste	No passwords, API keys or confidential project details in prompts or file names.
5	Only trusted add-ons	MCPs and skills run code on your machine. Check where they come from first.

The brain and the hands

The **AI model** (in the cloud) plans and writes a script. **Your computer** runs it; ffmpeg converts locally. **Your footage is not uploaded.**

What does go up: your prompt · file names and paths · command output (like clip specs) · text files it opens · **any frame or screenshot it looks at.**

When it matters: "Don't view any frames. Check the specs only."

Never in a GitHub repo

- Passwords, API keys, tokens
- Client or project data
- People's names and emails
- Internal paths, sheet IDs, Drive links
- Footage, renders, EXRs (media stays on Drive)

Repos start **private**. Deleting isn't erasing: a pushed secret is leaked. Replace it.

Keys and accounts

- **Never paste an API key into the chat.** Keys go in a `.env` file (blocked from git by the starter-pack `.gitignore`); the assistant tells you where.
- **Keys never go in a web page or desktop app.** Anyone can look inside those. They live on a backend: *frontend asks, backend spends*.
- **Set a spending limit** on every API account (fal.ai and the like).
- **Gradio share links are public** (anyone with the link, for about a week). Keep `share` off unless you mean it.

Files are safe when you follow the starter-pack rules

It works **only in the folder you open** · asks before acting · **never deletes** (unwanted files go to `_trash/`) · **never overwrites** (outputs go to `_converted/`) · keeps an **undo record** for batch renames · **proves** its work before saying "done". Use git as your undo button for code.

Be wary of hidden instructions. Web pages, downloaded repos and documents can contain text aimed at the assistant. Read approval prompts, especially after it has read something from the internet.